

Stage 3 — Trust, Liquidity & Marketplace Quality

Timing: Month 4–6 | Objective: Make the marketplace dependable enough for repeat usage

Primary task

Improve marketplace liquidity and trust so that customers can consistently find credible products and vendors can consistently receive useful demand.

Trust systems

- Implement vendor verification and visible trust signals.
- Use product and vendor reviews with safeguards against obvious abuse.
- Define buyer protection, refund and dispute processes.
- Provide clear order status and delivery tracking.
- Create a structured support workflow with response-time targets.

Marketplace liquidity

- Concentrate supply and demand in the categories and locations showing the strongest activity.
- Avoid spreading scarce customers across too many categories or cities.
- Encourage vendors to bring existing customers while Shopiva builds its own acquisition channels.
- Monitor out-of-stock products, poor response times and failed fulfillment.

Retention

- Measure first-to-second purchase conversion.
- Identify reasons customers do not return.
- Test post-purchase communication, personalized offers and relevant recommendations.
- Build retention around actual customer value rather than blanket discounts.

Lean Startup application

- Treat each trust or retention initiative as a hypothesis with a measurable expected outcome.
- Use cohort analysis to determine whether newer customers behave better than earlier cohorts after product/process changes.
- Persevere when evidence improves the key metrics; pivot when repeated experiments fail to address the underlying problem.

Exit criteria

- Order and delivery reliability has materially improved.
- Customers have understandable protection when something goes wrong.
- Vendor quality is manageable at the current scale.
- You can identify repeat customers and the behaviors associated with retention.

Founder question: What would make a customer comfortable moving from a first transaction to a second transaction without needing a large discount?

Framework reference: Eric Ries, *The Lean Startup* (Crown Business, 2011). This roadmap applies Lean Startup concepts such as validated learning, the Build–Measure–Learn loop, minimum viable product (MVP), innovation accounting, and pivot/persevere decisions. It does not reproduce the book's text.